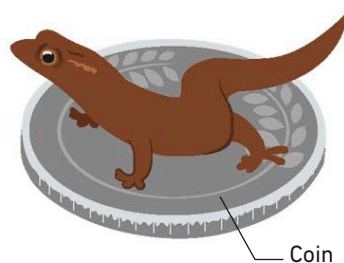


BIGGEST GATHERING

EACH **SPRING** INSIDE THE SNAKE DENS OF NARCISSE, **MANITOBA, CANADA**, **75,000** **RED-SIDED GARTER SNAKES** CONGREGATE IN A MATING FRENZY, WITH UP TO **100 MALES** VYING FOR **EVERY FEMALE**.



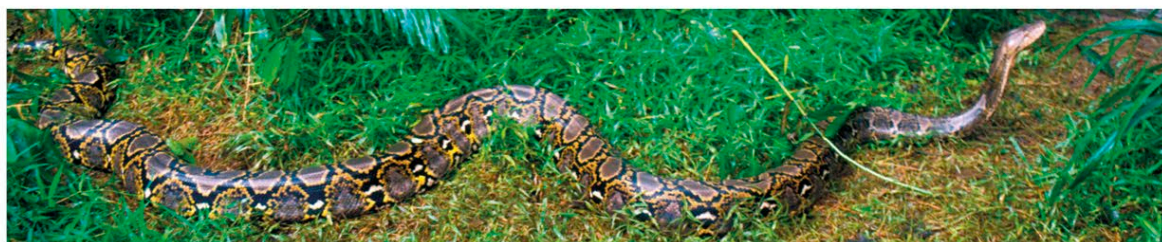
SMALLEST REPTILE



THE **VIRGIN ISLANDS DWARF SPHAERO** IS ONLY **5/8 IN (1.6 CM)** LONG.

OLDEST REPTILE

BORN IN **1832**, THE **OLDEST-LIVING** LAND ANIMAL IS A **SEYCHELLES GIANT TORTOISE** CALLED **JONATHAN**.



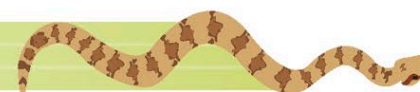
LONGEST REPTILE

THE **RETICULATED PYTHON** OF SOUTHEAST ASIA HAS SET THE RECORD-BREAKING LENGTH OF **33 FT (10 M)**.

FASTEST REPTILE

In a reptilian race between the fastest snake and swiftest lizard, the lizard would easily cross the finish line first.

FASTEST SNAKE: SIDEWINDER AT 18 MPH (28 KPH)



FASTEST LIZARD: BEARDED DRAGON AT 25 MPH (40 KPH)



SNAKE MOTION

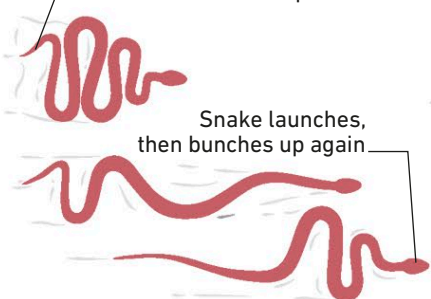
A snake can move in four main ways. Some species can switch between styles of moving, depending on the surface.



Straight

Scales along a snake's belly provide traction on the ground for it to propel itself in a line, using the muscles around its long ribcage.

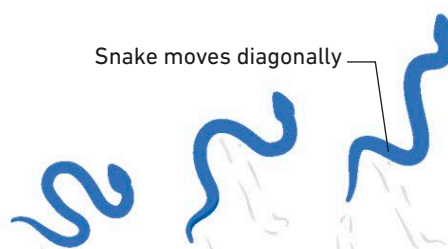
Tail is pressed to the ground as snake bunches up



Snake launches, then bunches up again

Concertina

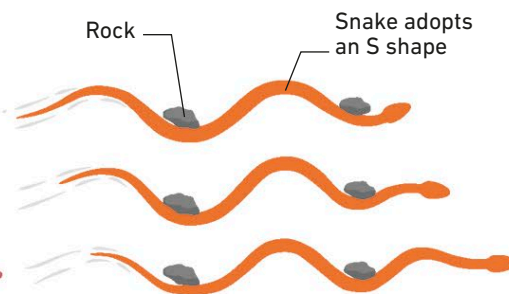
To get a good grip on a smooth surface, a snake can bunch up before pulling its back end up and launching itself forward.



Snake moves diagonally

Sidewinding

In open spaces such as sandy deserts, some snakes fling their head sideways through the air, with the rest of the body following.



Rock

Snake adopts an S shape

Serpentine

This common style involves a snake pushing itself off a bump on a surface or an object, and continuing forward in a wavy motion.

HIGHEST-LIVING REPTILE



THE **RED TAIL TOAD-HEADED LIZARD** HAS BEEN SEEN AT **17,390 FT (5,300 M)**. IT LIVES IN THE **QIANGTANG PLATEAU** IN **NORTHERN TIBET**.

SMART REPTILE

The mugger crocodile in India has been observed using sticks to lure birds, such as egrets or herons, who may be looking to build a nest. It waits motionless and partially submerged, then snaps up its unsuspecting prey when it is close enough.

